BODY-WORN CAMERAS AND PROCEDURAL JUSTICE IN SRI LANKA

A QUALITATIVE ANALYSIS OF STAKEHOLDERS' PERCEPTIONS AND INSTITUTIONAL CHALLENGES

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Introduction: The global acceptance of Body-Worn Cameras (BWCs) in policing has gained attention over the past few years, improving accountability, transparency, procedural fairness, and police-civilian interactions. With this, the Sri Lanka Police announced the integration plan of BWC into its operational framework by the end of 2026, yet no announcement was made for any operational guidelines, data protection framework, or judicial protocol. The overall aim of this study is to examine the procedural benefits and challenges of body-worn camera deployment in Sri Lankan procedural justice. **Methods:** The qualitative research design was used. Utilising purposive sampling, seven participants were recruited for key informant interviews. Interviews conducted remotely via Zoom and Microsoft Teams. The gathered data were analysed through Reflexive Thematic Analysis. **Results:** Results found enhanced with quality of evidence and fair trials, institutional legitimacy, deterrence of misconduct and bribery, and long-term evidence preservation as procedural benefits. Absence of the legal and legislative framework, selective recordings, ethical concerns and socio-economic bias were some of the identified procedural challenges. **Conclusion:** The study establishes that BWC deployment is not merely a technical implementation but also reforms the criminal justice system in Sri Lanka. Developing a pilot framework, arranging training programmes, enacting proper legislation related to the BWC and developing a privacy framework connected with co-partner arrangements are some of the recommendations brought by the study.

Keywords: Body Worn Camera, Benefits, Procedural Challenges, Procedural Justice, Stakeholder Perception.

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ABBREVIATIONS

BWC	Body Worn Camera
MET	The London Metropolitan Police Services
CCTV	Closed-Circuit Television
PIM	Perceived Intensity of Monitoring
PJT	Procedural Justice Theory
RTA	Reflexive Thematic Analysis
SMART	Secured, Mobile, Artificial Intelligence Driven, Real-time, Technology
UIDAI	Unique Identification Authority of India

1.0 INTRODUCTION

The global acceptance of Body-Worn Cameras (BWC) in policing has gained significant attention over the past few years, improving accountability, transparency, procedural fairness, and police-civilian interactions. Based on evidence reported from most Western countries, such as North America, Australia and Europe, this modern tool has assisted in reducing the complaints against law enforcement. These studies assist in justifying the effectiveness of body-worn cameras and procedural justice throughout their use in different jurisdictions and cultural settings, with numerous benefits and concerns (Ariel et al., 2015; Davies & Krame, 2023; Davies & Krame, 2023; Douglas, 2021).

In comparison to the Western context, the Sri Lanka Police is putting its effort into moving forward, adapting to the new technology, managing its challenges, though it is still far more behind globally (Yapa et al., 2021). The current policing environment in Sri Lanka addresses the urgency of the deployment of BWCs. Between January and December of 2025, Sri Lanka Police announced 22,153 accidents and 2,732 fatalities due to road traffic accidents exhibiting public safety concerns (Summary-Report-on-Road-Traffic-Accidents, 2025).

Considering the statistical reports, the Sri Lanka Police has announced integrating BWC in September 2025 into its operational framework by the end of 2026 (Pahlihawadana, 2025). The initial procurement was planned with the purchase of 5000 BWC to address the current issue of bribery and corruption of police officers (Balasuriya, 2025). According to the Transparency International Corruption Perception Report, Sri Lanka placed 32nd out of 100 in the corruption index, which highlights the necessity of more transparency and accountability in governance (Transparency International, 2025, p. 05). However, this deployment procedure has not announced any operational guidelines, data protection framework or judicial protocol. This has currently led to a legal, ethical and legislative vacuum in the Criminal Justice System in Sri Lanka. To address the urgency of a strong policy framework, the BWC should function as a surveillance tool that protects both civilians and law enforcement officials, rather than a repression mechanism (Mateescu et al., 2016; Stanley, 2015).

The presence of a body-worn camera does not fully guarantee procedural justice due to numerous reasons. In the contemporary context, police-community relationships have often been identified as authoritative and harsh rather than more friendly service-oriented (Widanapathirana, 2016). The Sri Lankan Criminal Justice System has been challenged by institutional weaknesses, including ethical, legal, technical, and cultural aspects (Lum et al., 2020, p. 95; Miranda, 2022). Not only Sri Lanka, but also South Asian countries need proper intervention and strategic plans to ensure the proper functioning of the BWC (Saxena, 2025; Tantimin & Abdurrakhman, 2024). However, against the accusations of police officers, deployment of BWC is necessary not as a technical tool but as a supporting tool to strengthen the transparency and the accountability of law enforcement in Sri Lanka (Widanapathirana, 2016). Despite a massive increase in research on the BWC deployment in the Western context, there is a complete absence of empirical data or peer-reviewed articles on the ethical and policy implementation of BWC in the Sri Lankan context, highlighting a significant geographical and research gap.

1.1 Aim and the Research Objectives

The overall aim of this study is to examine the procedural benefits and challenges of BWC deployment in the Sri Lankan procedural justice.

- To identify the procedural benefits that stakeholders perceive in implementing BWC in the Sri Lankan Criminal Justice System.
- To identify challenges or risks that stakeholders perceive in relation to implementing BWC in Sri Lanka

1.2 Research Questions

- What procedural benefits do stakeholders perceive in implementing BWC in the Sri Lankan Criminal Justice System?
- What challenges do stakeholders perceive in relation to implementing BWC in Sri Lanka?

1.3 Previous Studies related to BWC

The emergence of body-worn cameras has become one of the widely known technological tools utilised in the criminal justice system. Currently, studies related to the BWC deployment have largely been limited to the Western context. Lum et al. (2020) found 70 studies across BWC. Studies conducted in relation to BWC, law enforcement officers and citizens demonstrated a positive picture towards implementation (Fallik et al., 2020; Gaub et al., 2016; Huff et al., 2022; Jennings et al., 2015; Todak et al., 2024). When tracing the history of BWC deployment, the United Kingdom (UK) was the first nation to employ BWCs in its front-line police operations in 2007, after allocating £6 million to the initial project (Zgurova, 2024). The pilot project of BWC deployment conducted in 2014 announced that TASER Axon 500 cameras were deployed to London MET police officers (Zgurova, 2024). This adaptation has established greater transparency and accountability among law enforcement globally.

In the criminal justice system, BWCs and procedural justice are intertwined as footage provides objective evidence to support in evaluating police-citizen interactions (Van Hall et al., 2022). This helps to create a positive effect on the perception of police legitimacy, which helps to promote respectful interactions with transparency (Demir, 2026; Demir et al., 2020). Findings of Demir et al. (2020) emphasise the benefits of the function of BWC and the legitimacy gained through the improvements of procedural justice. According to the study conducted by Ariel et al., (2015), Braga et al., (2018) and Jennings et al., (2015) findings modify the effect for both police officers and civilians, ensuring accountability through reducing the use of force by 58.3% and citizen complaints by 88% . Moreover, studies conducted by Headley et al., (2017), Milidragović et al.,(2025), White et al., (2017) Yokum et al., (2019) findings established that BWCs have a positive impact on police procedures while Todak et al. (2024) highlighted that BWCs involved with traffic and drug-related cases are processed quickly in the court procedure.

However, the absence of procedural justice may affect functionality, leading to misuse, creating issues, including privacy and ethical concerns, in the BWCs deployment (Houwing & van Eck, 2020; Newell, 2017). This is essential due to the absence of legislation on the question of admissibility and the integrity of the chain of custody (Bellin & Pemberton, 2019; Saxena, 2025, p. 300). The

deployment of BWC has gained attention due to the asymmetric power between civilians and police officers. According to Ferguson (2017), smart policing has pushed police departments to recreate patterns of discrimination and exclusion through algorithms, where people of colour and other marginalised groups may be victimised (Mateescu et al., 2016; Shmathko, 2017). This emphasised the surveillance and privacy, not merely a negotiable factor, but placed in a significant position when establishing legal and legislative policies (Mateescu et al., 2016).

The accountability for the ethical initiation of BWC depends on a strong policy framework. Especially the protection of the vulnerable groups during the sensitive encounters (Stanley, 2015). With the initiation of the BWC, the participatory panopticon has increased in visibility of police misconduct through the media. However, this depends on the activation of the BWC by law enforcement, that captured by citizens. Yet, there is no right to access to these recordings by civilians (Mateescu et al., 2016; Newell, 2014; Stanley, 2015). Newell (2014) stresses that law enforcement holds sole responsibility for managing, accessing, and controlling these recordings, which has led to questions about accountability and civilian trust.

Growing studies of BWC deployment reflect inadequate adaptation to the legislative framework. This raises the question of the accountability of institutions that may have the ability to manipulate or alter gathered digital evidence by a proxy (Ferguson, 2017; Newell, 2014). However, studies conducted by Bellin & Pemberton, (2019) raise the issue of the inadequate standardised legal framework availability for BWC in the USA. This has led to questions about the chain of custody, admissibility, and integrity of the evidence due to the patchwork of evidentiary rulings. The study of Fan (2018) on policy analysis found that out of 59 major police departments in US cities, some of the departments lacked of BWC footage retention policies for civil suits against police, exposing inadequate data management. A similar issue related to inadequate data management has been highlighted by the study of Saxena, (2025) and Mishra (2023) bringing attention to the data breach of UIDAI in Aadhaar, where data was found on sale on the dark web. This features the lack of a coherent legislative system on protecting data, not only creates evidentiary uncertainty, but also leading to the misuse of those videos.

Literature related to technical challenges identified constraints that may affect the BWC deployment. The systematic review by Lum et al., (2019) identified inconsistent camera activation and the lack of officer training as the main cause of technical errors, emphasising that deployment alone does not certify efficiency of the technology. Moreover, longitudinal findings of Gaub et al., (2016) and Miranda, (2022) highlight the capacity of audio and video recording, the insufficient procedure of data transfer and data storage as major technical challenges. Furthermore, these technical issues link with operational level, where selective recordings and non-activation of cameras led to an increased workload burden to the police officers.

Notably, most of the BWS studies have been centred on the Western context, leaving the South Asian context unexplored, including Sri Lanka. These findings of are limited in explaining the generalisability of the South Asian context, as the governing structure, police community relationships, and dynamics differ from

those of the Western context. Therefore, the present study aims to study the procedural benefits and challenges of BWC deployment from the perspective of the criminal justice stakeholders in Sri Lanka.

1.4 Theoretical Framework

The theoretical framework of this study consists of three theories: the Procedural Justice theory developed by Tom R. Tyler (1990) and the Deterrence theory by Cesare Beccaria and Jeremy Bentham (1764), combined with the self-awareness theory by Shelly Duval and Robert Wicklund (1972).

1.4.1 Procedural Justice Theory

The Procedural Justice Theory is one of the prominent theories introduced by Tom R. Tyler (1990) through his study, “Why People Obey the Law, " which has been utilised in criminal justice research related to the perception of law enforcement agencies (Chan et al., 2025). According to Tyler, this theory consists of voice, neutrality, respect and trustworthiness, where these four principles treat civilians with fairness (Mohler et al., 2022). The core of this instrumental model suggests that evaluation of police performance, risk and distributive justice depends on the people’s willingness to accept and cooperate with the authorities (Gau, 2014; Sunshine & Tyler, 2003). Moreover, legitimacy from the perspective of PJT is an essential component in which people believe authorities are guided by righteousness. In supporting legitimacy, BWC deployment provides a more transparent and accountable police service, ensuring that the people voluntarily believe and obey the authorities (Chan et al., 2025; Van Hall et al., 2022). Conversely, Tyler's argument on PJT supports the BWC deployment, which provides a structural mechanism that assists quality decision-making processes in an unbiased manner to maintain long-term legitimacy (Tyler, 2003). Within the PJT literature, police legitimacy is determined by three criteria: obligation to obey, normative alignment, and legality, where BWC deployment ensures that the police actions are within the lawful boundary (Chan et al., 2025; Jackson & Bradford, 2010). According to the three major components, people express their moral duty to follow the police instructions even though it is against their interests, considering the legal validity (Meares et al., 2015). Considering all, the core principles of procedural justice have ensured giving voice to the individuals and making sure they are heard, with proper transparency and accountability through a systematic observation (Barber & Tankebe, 2024; Dlugolenski et al., 2025; Leben, 2019).

1.4.2 Deterrence Theory

The deterrence theory mainly focuses on the rationale that if people are aware of the gravity of the offence and the severity of its consequences, they would be more likely to abide by the rule (Demir, 2019). Theory includes the classical components, i.e., certainty, severity, and celerity, which influence offenders’ decision-making and their likelihood of refraining from committing crimes, as there is a real chance of getting caught with integrated penalties to their behaviour (Ariel et al., 2018; Tomlinson, 2016). In the context of the BWC, this would help to detect any misconduct by law enforcement officials or civilians through creating a panopticon effect, which helps to understand the citizen perception and behaviour, as deterrence, which is operationalised by self-awareness that affects

the police discretion (Tankebe & Ariel, 2016). These footages would help serve as a close observer, which acts as a deterrent (Ariel et al., 2015; Ariel et al., 2018), and helps to enhance the public trust by improving the police behaviour (Demir et al., 2020). When applying this theory to the study, the Sri Lankan policing system has been challenged by several serious concerns, and in this context, BWC serves not only as a simple tool but also as a deterrent for both officers and civilians. Deterrence theory gives a proper explanation of how and why the presence of BWC changes the procedure outcomes functions. Lum et al. (2020) explain the perception of police officers heightening their awareness towards the deterrence function due to BWC.

1.4.3 Self-Awareness Theory

Self-awareness theory offers a dual role of increasing observation of both police and civilian behaviour. According to Shelly Duval and Robert Wicklund (1972), self-awareness can be experimentally induced, and it is a psychosocial process that can assist in regulating behaviour (Ariel et al., 2018). This theory is also known as the "objective self-awareness theory", where the utilisation of BWC reminds both parties that they are constantly observed, which reduces the misconduct behaviour and aligns with the socially accepted behaviour (Demir, 2019). Furthermore, anything that directs the attention of the individual self can lead to self-awareness (Wicklund, 1972, p. 234). Wearing BWC can gain attention towards self-awareness, where police officers can make decisions consciously, following up on the lawful and procedurally accepted behaviour (Ariel, 2016; Ariel et al., 2015; McCluskey et al., 2019). Applying this theory to the study explains that the internal cognitive functions of police officers trigger their attention with BWC through creating a deterrence stimuli that connects with the police officer's environment (Jennings et al., 2015; Ready & Young, 2015) . Together, the theoretical chain precisely reflects BWC recordings, raises self-awareness, which deters misconduct of both police officers and civilians (deterrence and self-awareness theory), and leads both civilians and officers to adhere to the accepted procedural process (procedural actions), generating procedural outcomes (Procedural Justice Theory).

2.0 METHODOLOGY

2.1 Research Design, Population and Sampling

The study is designed as qualitative research to gain a deeper understanding of the stakeholders' perceptions of BWC deployment (Fathullah et al., 2025; Setia, 2017). In this study, the qualitative approach has allowed to identify implementation benefits and challenges to address the necessary stakeholders (Guzik et al., 2021). The study was conducted with seven individuals who accepted the invitation to take part in the interviews from the 11th of February 2026 to the 28th of February 2026. The sample was selected through purposive sampling. This method has assisted in gathering in-depth, rich information from responses, including knowledge related to the particular subject (Tongco, 2007). Furthermore, this enhances the credibility and confirmability of research findings, establishing the overall trustworthiness of the study. (Memon et al., 2024). Two civil academics, three legal persons and two police officers were selected for the

study. Participants were identified through the professional network through personal contacts, considering their direct engagement with the Criminal Justice System. The identified participants were contacted through email. Through the sample of seven, data saturation was achieved.

2.2 Data Collection Method

To achieve the objectives of the study, both primary and secondary data were utilised. Key informant interviews with open-ended questions were the main data collection technique utilised in the study (Appendix No 01). These interviews were conducted for those who accepted the invitation to participate. The interview guide was developed in English based on prior literature. To prepare the interview guide, studies conducted by Lum et al. (2019), White et al. (2017), Harrison et al. (2022), Demire (2023), and Putra & Yazid were utilised.

The questions and probing questions were structured to gain more descriptive and qualitative insights from the respondents. The interview guide consisted of eight sections, ranging from the respondent's demographics to closing reflections on the Body-worn Cameras. Before conducting interviews, all the appointments for the interviews were made through telephone calls (WhatsApp). This preparation helps the interviewee and the researcher to reach a properly prepared discussion on all the thematic areas and provides a credible source to provide information with data saturation more effectively (Fallik et al., 2020). The research is solely based on an academic nature. Data collection was conducted remotely, and interviews were conducted on weekends, as most respondents preferred to participate in the interviews at weekends. The interviews lasted 30 to 45 minutes. The interviews were conducted through Zoom and Microsoft Teams, and the respondent had the option to choose the platform according to their connection. This was beneficial for the study as it helped to meet the response on time and conduct multiple interviews per day within a shorter time period. (Archibald et al., 2019; Deakin & Wakefield, 2014). Prior to the interview, all the instructions were given to the respondent to gain consent to record the interview sessions and provide the opportunity to skip or deny answering the questions. This step intends that the respondent fully understand their participation in the study and disclose the necessary crucial information for the study (Xu et al., 2020). Manuscripts were automatically generated during the process of video recording, and the correction of the dialogue was done manually by the researcher.

2.3 Data Analysis

The study utilised the Reflexive Thematic Analysis (RTA) method employed by Braun and Clarke (2022), the six-step approach, which is commonly applied to analyse materials such as interviews. This technique allows the researcher to identify, analyse and report the identified data patterns, providing a more organised and detailed understanding under different themes in a critical perspective (Braun & Clarke, 2022, p. 5).

The initial stage of the research started with familiarising with the data through continuous listening to the videos and reading the transcripts to identify the preliminary information for the coding. The researcher used the hard copies of the transcripts to engage in this process. For the second step, initial codes were generated manually. Coding was conducted systematically and inductively to

generate semantic codes through direct quotes of the participants. This followed the data-driven, coding, ensuring the sub-themes were generated through an interpretative manner (Braun & Clarke, 2022, pp. 53–54). After identifying the initial codes, sub-themes were created through clustering relevant codes together, by refining and examining them according to the research questions. Fourthly, sub-themes were further examined to create themes. However, during the process, some of the sub-themes were merged, not compromising the core of the thematic structure. The fifth step involved naming the themes capturing the core of the two research questions. The final step involves producing the analysis by integrating the extracted data that addresses the two research questions (Braun & Clarke, 2022, p. 39). The following table highlights the coding of the study, from the point of extracting data from verbatim quotes through initial coding, sub-themes and themes. Based on the participant data, 10 sub-themes were created, bridging two main themes. The first theme addressed the procedural benefits of implementing the BWC in the Sri Lankan Criminal Justice System to strengthen the current policy framework. The second research question captures its implementation challenges through 06 sub-theme.

Table 1. Subthemes related to the main themes research questions one and two

Research Question	**Initial coding**	**Sub themes**	**Themes**
RQ 01	i. Objective documentation ii. Evidence reliability iii. visual evidence iv. equal access v. Mutual Protection	Quality of Evidence and Fair Trial	Procedural Benefits
	i. Institutional Reliability ii. Institutional Legitimacy and Accountability	Institutional Legitimacy	
	i. Reduction of misconduct ii. Behaviour regulation iii. Anti-Bribery	Deterrence of misconduct	
	i. Long-term evidence preservation ii. Criminal intent	Criminal Intent	
RQ 02	i. Lack of a legislative framework ii. Necessity of legal reform iii. Inadequate procedural guidelines	Absence of a Legal and Legislative Framework	

	i. Partial recording ii. Court Delays iii. Secondary Investigation	Selective Recordings and Court Delays	Implementation Challenges
	i. Data Security ii. Evidence tampering	Data Storage and Technical Infrastructure	
	i. Marginalised groups and Vulnerable groups	Ethical Concerns	
	Socioeconomic Bias Power Imbalance	Socio-Economic Bias	
	Political Interference	Political Interference	

2.4 Ethical Considerations and Limitations

The relevant documents for the ethical approval were submitted for the supervisor to review, if the researcher needs to apply for ethical clearance. With the supervisor's comments, it was noted that the researcher does not need to process the document through the ethical review committee, as the research questions and the interview guide of the study predominantly focused on gathering perceptions of experts on the institutional benefits and challenges of BWC deployment. The interview guide does not contain sensitive questions related to the participants' health, religion, ethnicity, political opinion, criminal offences or victimisation. The study strictly adhered to the Swedish ethical guidelines for the study.

As the sample was small, necessary precautions were taken to protect the confidentiality and anonymity of the participants. To avoid the professional risk to participants, the researcher kept anonymity through removing all personal details, including designation, police rank, and year of service, court affiliation, or supreme court registration number that could reveal the participant. This ensures that participants would not be exposed to any professional or institutional consequences resulting from the participation. Throughout the results and the discussion sections, participants were addressed as ‘law enforcement officials, police officials’ or ‘legal experts’ to ensure that their original identities could not be traced.

During the data collection process, one of the ethical dilemmas exposed by the researcher was handling personal experiences expressed by the participant. When personal experience related to bribery was disclosed by the participant, only information relevant to the research questions was included. No direct quotes related to such disclosure were utilised in the study. Furthermore, the study discusses lower-income civilians and the LGBTQI+ community without directly interviewing them. This has been addressed by the researcher in the limitations section as a suggestion for future studies, representing more inclusive representations.

To handle the consent, before the interviews, participants were provided with a copy of the interview guide (Appendix 01), the consent form for the participant,

and an information sheet (Appendix 02) by the researcher. This included the details of the data gathering procedure, handling and minimising the risk for the participants. Forms were sent to the participants two days before the interview. The researcher explained all the key information to the respondent and requested verbal consent before recording the conversation. The participant's consent was obtained through the consent form as proof. Entire participation in the study was voluntary. Participants were informed of their right to skip any question from the study at any time. After gathering the data, the recordings were downloaded to the local storage. The downloaded data were stored in password-protected portable hardware. After transcribing, the video recordings were deleted to ensure data protection and the security of the respondent's privacy and no further access to those information by a third party. Participants were fully informed about the purpose of the study, how it was carried out and how data would be handled through the information sheet.

The Grammarly AI tool was utilised only for enhancing the grammatical corrections and spellings of the document. No AI-generated content was included in the work. The use of the tool has not impacted the originality of the content or integration of AI into the data analysis.

3.0 RESULTS

3.1 Procedural Benefits

Quality of Evidence and Fair Trial

This section primarily investigates the procedural benefits that can be gained from BWC deployment in the Sri Lankan context. Respondents across law enforcement. Legal and civil academics who voluntarily participated in the interviews for this section stressed:

"...BWC would provide an objective record of interactions, which can protect both police and civilians and strengthen the reliability of evidence in court proceedings."

BWC is a technology tool that provides an unbiased, clear, and real-time digital witness recording, making the evidence more reliable. This reliability provides support with access to the recording that both the defence and prosecution can use in court. And this will assist in ensuring "the legal process is fair and based on documented facts". Furthermore, all stakeholders agreed that:

"A camera recording gives an objective record that both the prosecution and the defence can use, which makes the investigation fairer."

This emphasises the importance of equal access to the footage by both the prosecution and the defence, which ensures transparency and reduces the conflicting statements that may occur through the verbal testimonies. Also, Legal experts believed:

"Instead of relying solely on written reports or witness testimony, judges and lawyers may have access to visual evidence showing the interaction between police officers and suspects."

This could help ensure greater fairness during investigations and trials, as both parties have access to the videos by both parties. This can be supported by clear regulations to reduce bias, and this protects the constitutional rights by giving access to a fair trial.

Institutional Legitimacy

Bridging the gap between External and internal accountability of institutions is one of the crucial processes to establish public confidence and institutional legitimacy. Civil academic participants believe:

"When people see that police conduct is being recorded and reviewed, it sends a clear message that the institution is serious about being accountable."

This sends a clear message to the institution that it's not only the officer who does the recording, but also that the institution is accountable for any misconduct. The gathered data from all the stakeholder groups demonstrates that this would enhance perceived reliability and professionalism. Moreover, another significant aspect is that:

"BWCs could help people feel that the system is more reliable, just, and professional, which can improve the legitimacy of law enforcement institutions in Sri Lanka." (Civil Academic, February 14, 2026)

This transition provides a fairer investigation process compared to the current practical scenario. BWC deployment will assist in purifying the system, ensuring the law is executed properly rather than being bent based on favouritism.

Deterrence of Misconduct

One of the purposes of BWC deployment is to deter the misconduct of both officers and civilians. Utilising BWC in the current procedures will assist in "… reduce improper actions, human rights violations, fundamental rights violations, especially the police torture of civilians…, BWC would encourage more disciplined and professional behaviour of police officers." Moreover, the presence of video recording would reduce the fabrication of stories or reports of evidence, which leads to contradictions and omissions in the court process. If the law enforcement agencies encourage the use of the "BWC, police won't be able to fabricate such types of statements, as the actual situation is recorded." Thereby, the protection of the victim and the witness is ensured rather than becoming the victim of the system. Furthermore, addressing the fact that officers take bribes, which could be sorted out by implementing BWC. With this transparency, "police officers won't be able to ask for a bribe from civilians", which will discourage the traditional corrupt system that promotes the professionalism and self-awareness of both civilians and police officers.

Distinguishing Criminal Intent

Based on the responses, some respondents saw BWC deployment as a transformative technological tool for documenting accidents, which tries to move beyond the boundaries of conventional note-taking. Police participant highlighted that:

"…BWCs are very useful in distinguishing intent. In some incidents that initially appear to be fatal accidents, may be planned murders".

BWC is one of the useful and essential tools that can capture all stages of an event from beginning to end, which can later be used to analyse the actions of the suspect. This would help to identify the real victim and the culprit, and the investigators could revisit the footage years later. Furthermore, both civil academics and police officers noted that:

"Since court cases for serious crimes can extend for many years, sometimes even up to two decades, having a permanent video record is essential for uncovering the truth long after the event."

This highlights that human memory is insufficient to provide testimony in cases that remain in court for extended periods. Especially in criminal cases, it will take at least 20 years to reach a verdict, which emphasises the need for adequate access to evidence during the lengthy judicial process.

3.2 Implementation Challenges

Absence of a Legal and Legislative Framework

Based on the gathered data, the major concern brought by the civil academics and legal experts was an inadequate legislative framework for the implementation of the BWC. The matter right now is that "There is no legislation with regard to the BWC or such a type of system in Sri Lanka*".* This is a major concern when implementing BWC footage as evidence in the court process. The Amendment of 2006 to the Evidence Ordinance has allowed the use of audio or video recording as computer evidence. However, based on the argument of legal expertise, due to the legislative gap, it is insufficient to bring the BWC footage to the court as reliable evidence. Another major concern brought by the respondent was the lack of an operational guide, and "no clear rules on" how this footage should be stored and function and who has the authority to access this review footage.

"We also need an Act from Parliament to make this video footage valid as expert evidence in court." (Legal expert, February 22, 2026)

Beyond the legislation level, respondents believed that there should be clear operational procedures, "there should be clear-cut policies and regulations, and they should be published in the gazette."

Selective Recordings and Court Delays

Due to the non-implementation of BWC, police officers and civilians have started to use their mobile phones to capture certain incidents between police officers and

civilians, which has made huge controversial. According to one of the police participants, one of the issues arose due to the selective recording. “A police officer starts the video from where he wants to start the video. And the public, they are starting the video, at the point of using cameras, if they want to start the video. So, the justice is not being sought properly” by providing the ability to misguide the community.

Currently, the Sri Lankan legal system is struggling with court delays, where approximately 4 to 5 years are required to conclude a criminal case and 10 to 12 years to finish a civil case. However, the major issue pointed out by all stakeholders was selective or partial recording as. “If we use these BWC as evidence, court delay may be increased.”

As a selective recording, do not show the entire scenario; “the court may need to do another investigation to find out the entire scenario to find the entire story behind the partial video.” This shows the requirement of secondary investigation, which extends the time required to conclude the case. Moreover, this may lead to bringing arguments, but the defence lawyers argue that “detrimental to the client due to selective recordings or technical manipulation” that challenge the admissibility of the evidence.

Data Storage and Technical Infrastructure

One of the major concerns raised by the respondents in this section is issues related to the technical infrastructure and the data storage. These technical issues have been addressed by law enforcement officials and civil academics, highlighting:

“…ensure data protection and secure storage and restricted access because if the access is to a number of officers, then there may be some issues on the reliability of the evidence, because sometimes they can fabricate, change the evidence.”

To prevent the manipulation, having a proper infrastructure is a must. In such situations, the system should be operated by the IT division of the police to protect footage from outside officials. As police participants highlighted, “there should be a massive storage system”, concerning massive data storage, which demands considerable technological investments to establish storage infrastructure.

Ethical Concerns

When questioning about the BWC deployment, the major concern raised by all respondents was consent and privacy. This concern is built on personal privacy, which may be disturbed due to social media engagement with this digital footage. Especially, selective footage may be released to “show the police are doing a 'great service”. However, the vulnerable community, during such recording may cause discomfort or uncooperative behaviour due to their personal reasons. Based on the gathered data, one respondent explicitly said, “I would feel uncomfortable being recorded without consent. There is also a risk of misuse of footage.” This demonstrated the necessity of proper procedure to prevent re-victimisation in similar situations.

"...I worry about the LGBTQI+ community. Some people view them as 'strange', and they are not accepted by society. Officers might perform unnecessary harassment on them." (Legal expert, February 28, 2026).

This statement highlights that these individuals may become more exploited or exposed to unnecessary harassment by these officials, as there are no proper, clear guidelines. This situation is one of the crucial and non-negotiable prerequisites for the BWC deployment, even for a pilot study. In such a situation, proper, clear guidelines on "who can access, how data is collected, stored, shared, and used in court and mechanisms of requesting footage" should be considered to mitigate the risks that may arise when implementing BWC for the first time in the Sri Lankan context.

Socio-economic and Power Bias

Based on the perceptions of the civil academic participants, it is observed that the type of vehicle serves as a major component that reflects the social status. This is shown from the quote:

"*If you go on a bike or if you go in a small car, the treatment that you get is not the same if you were driving a BMW or Montero."* (Civil academic, February 14, 2026).

The luxurious vehicles like BMW and Prado are often treated as having a higher social status and are reputable among the traffic law enforcement officials. Conversely, those who use bikes, tuk-tuk, are subjected to ill treatment. Most respondents believe that the strong power imbalance is deeply embedded in society, where "the power difference is very clear as a civilian, you do not always feel comfortable questioning a police officer, even when you think you have done nothing wrong."

However, perceptions among civil participants were that "police officers love their uniform, and they love to abuse the power entitled to the uniform and fairness is based on the conditional, depending on who you are and how you interact with the official." In addition, law enforcement officials and civil respondents also revealed similar information related to political and hierarchical influence issues. Dropping the names of ministers or higher influential people during the violation of traffic law is a considerable challenge in the Sri Lankan context right now**.**

"...the political system in Sri Lanka is actually corrupt. Therefore, if anything is recorded in the BWC which is detrimental to a particular political leader... then they may fear, or there may be a particular threat to the police officer." (Civil, February 15, 2026).

Such situations highlight potential workplace pressure or harassment against traffic police officers who do not follow unofficial orders of their superiors. Moreover, this may create fear of documenting the truth. This draws the attention of all participants to the need for a strong legal framework to protect officers from such situations.

Prevalence of Corruption and Bribery

This prominent sub-theme is deeply rooted, like the corruption and bribery within Sri Lankan traffic police officers. Respondents have expressed a strong conviction that many police officers prioritise their financial gain through such situations. According to one of the legal professionals:

"*...I thoroughly believe that they are corrupted, sometimes most of them are corrupted, because sometimes they are trying to give fines, but if we are trying to give them bribes/money, then they are not going to sue against us."*

This suggests officers act partially and are desirable for the bribes rather than following through with lawful penalties. Moreover, the gathered data highlights that asking for bribes is not always direct but can be framed through coded language or indirect questions, which can confuse civilians. According to one of the civil academic participants, the situation is as follows:

"He asked just general questions... then he asked if I should give you a ticket? And I didn't know this at the time, he is apparently asking for a bribe."

During the interview, the participant interpreted it as an attempt to initiate a bribe, nothing else. Considering these situations, all the respondents strongly believe in implementation of BWC would serve as a powerful deterrence.

4.0 DISCUSSION

This study aimed to connect two research questions focusing on identifying the procedural significance and challenges of BWC deployment from the perception of stakeholders that may arise in implementing BWC in the Sri Lankan Criminal Justice System. The gathered results from the data will be further discussed in the following sections.

4.1 Benefits

Public Confidence and Institutional Legitimacy

The study results stress BWC as a mechanism for bridging external-internal accountability and institutional trust. In relation to theories, the trustworthiness of procedural justice theory makes BWC deployment structurally view the performance of citizens (Tyler, 2006, pp. 270–271). This supports institutional moral justification, legal validity and institutional authority in institutional legitimacy that is violated by some police officers. The present findings of the study support the findings of the quasi-experimental study of Demir et al., (2020). Findings highlight that BWC assists in improving the legitimacy of the Turkish police officers, which demonstrates similar characteristics to the Sri Lankan police system. This has been acknowledged in officers' "lawful conduct", exhibiting their professional standard that impacts the picture of the institute and the performance of the officers (Ariel et al., 2016; Demir, 2026; Kang, 2023). However, the findings of the study provide a necessity of performative accountability and legitimate institutional performance, as the absence of

structured accountability, reform may cause risk to both civilians and the institute (Ariel et al., 2016; Tankebe & Ariel, 2016).

Fair Trial

Based on the stakeholder group's responses, BWC provides real-time recordings for both defence and prosecution, with properly documented facts. From a procedural theory perspective, BWC assists in providing neutral, formal decision-making through independent recording (Tyler, 2006, pp. 6–7) maintaining quality fair treatment by both parties. The process assists in gaining public trust in the legal system (Blader & Tyler, 2003). The findings of Colin Bolger & Walters, (2019) emphasised that the procedural justice framework by Tom Tyler established that the people who are treated fairly by police cooperate more with the officers, which adds that the language tone is also a significant component. The study findings of Ariel et al., (2015) and Todak et al., (2024) support the research findings of the study, demonstrating that BWC footage helps to conduct speedy and efficient judicial procedures by improving the quality of the evidence. However, the study of Bellin & Pemberton (2019) and Petersen et al.,(2023) challenges the findings of the current study. Their studies challenge that when a police officer identifies unfavourable conditions for them, they might try to fabricate evidence. This will be entirely dependent on how the officer's discretion power is exercised on activation of their BWCs, as prosecutors report produced according to the activation of these cameras.

Professionalism

According to the self-awareness theory, it provides a psychological elaboration that continuous monitoring causes the activation of procedurally accepted personal standards (Duval, 1972, p. 2). The Perceived Intensity of Monitoring (PIM) (Adams & Mastracci, 2019) provides the opportunity for the institution to explore the perception of the discretion, disapproval, and distributional effects of police officers. Studies conducted by Gaub et al. (2016); Katz et al. (2014), Ready & Young (2015), Ariel et al. (2015), and Davies & Krame (2023) show that this has led less number of complaints against law enforcement officers by encouraging procedures that support the results. Harrison et al. (2022) stressed that 58.1% of law enforcement officials agreed that BWC has improved their public confidence in both normal and hard situations, improving their reputation. The findings of the study align with both previous findings and the self-awareness theory, where the BWC deployment supports self-regulatory behaviour, professional conduct and institutional legitimacy, providing a strong foundation for the Sri Lankan context.

Long-term Evidence Preservation and Criminal Intent

The participation findings highlight the significance of long-term preservation of BWC footage for investigating accidents and traffic violations. Based on the theoretical ground of procedural justice theory, the court proceedings must proceed through documented facts. This would add a deterrence effect where criminal actions are captured easily. The findings of Petersen et al. (2023) demonstrate 42 prosecutors in the US confirmed that BWC footages assist to establishing the criminal intent and reconstructing criminal cases, including driving under the influence of alcohol or reckless driving. Fan (2018) findings

focused on the short-term preservation of evidentiary footage for criminal prosecution. In the Sri Lankan judiciary system, criminal cases may extend to 10-20 years, which challenges the data retention time documented. Also, Wickramasooriya (2022) suggests that the long-term preservation may pose challenges to the admissibility in the Sri Lankan Criminal Justice System. Ultimately, the civil academics and police participants' findings support both benefits and challenges in the data preservation procedure, arguing for mandating a minimum of 90 days for a standard investigation time period.

4.2 Challenges

Absence of Legal and Legislative Framework

The most important challenge identified by all three stakeholder categories was the absence of supporting legislation related to BWC in the Sri Lankan context. The study findings emphasise that the existing Evidence (Special Provisions) Ordinance Act No. 14 of 1995 and the Electronic Transactions Act No. 19 of 2006, Sri Lanka, provide the opportunity to use audio and video recordings related to computer-generated evidence. Yet it does not address the activation of the BWC, the chain of custody, or other standard procedures related to court proceedings in Sri Lanka. This legal vacuum stresses the necessity of a recognised circular, ordinance, or an Act related to the BWC deployment. Theoretically, deterrence theory adds concerns to this vacuum. The current video evidence requires 45 days before the trial, which emphasises the procedural requirements and barriers to implementing BWC footage as evidence (Wickramasooriya, 2022). Without the Act, the chain of custody cannot lead to disciplinary action or legal consequences. Bellin & Pemberton, (2019), Newell (2017) and Zgurova (2024) demonstrated that developed countries like the UK, USA still lack essential legislation regarding metadata integrity and footage access rights. These results support this study's findings by evidence admissibility and disclosure obligations related to BWC, which have created tension between defendant privacy and evidentiary value.

Ethical Concerns

In the Sri Lankan context, data protection is established through the Data Protection Act No 09 of 2022. However, this act does not enact the data protection section in relation to BWC, specifically regarding data collection, sharing and the privacy protection of the individual. This legal vacuum allows police to have the opportunity to use BWC footage against vulnerable and minority groups who may become victims. The Brennan Centre for Justice (2019) emphasise these footages can be utilised as a powerful surveillance instrument. In the Sri Lankan context, a government bill and guidelines launched by the Human Rights Commission were introduced in 2023 to decriminalise same-sex acts and to protect transgender persons. However, police use their arbitrary powers against them. According to the study of Poirier et al. (2024), residents in Quebec, Canada, have raised their concerns about their consent related to the BWC recordings of children and vulnerable groups, as there would be a fundamental issue regarding their privacy. Specifically, such situations address strict access to footage, tampering with evidence, and a proper, clear, privacy-centric framework. The study of Ethan (2017) and Mateescu et al. (2016) show this approach serves the best privacy interest, serves accountability without causing any harm. Once the Act is enacted,

publish operational regulations in the Gazette under the Act to provide a proper channel to raise awareness about BWC among citizens and assist them with BWC-related issues. Theoretically, procedural justice mechanisms have become more transparent by giving a voice to citizens (Ariel et al., 2016; Van Hall et al., 2022) where the gazette gives a minimum structural condition for citizens to hold the police accountable, as the circulars and internal memorandums issued by the police department cannot be utilised as a justifiable right for citizens.

Selective Recordings and Court Delays

Based on the findings, selective recordings create a dual risk: misinterpretation of the situation and cause court delays. Ethan (2017), McCluskey et al. (2019) Miranda (2022) and Poirier et al. (2024) suggested activation and deactivation of the recording, poor quality of the footage, delays in video transfer, and identified situations that require secondary investigation, which add more time to the judicial process. Furthermore, this was validated by procedural justice theory, which challenges the neutrality dimension of fair process by violating the structural requirement. However, Ariel et al. (2016) emphasise that partial recoding taken by the police officers is a common problem that pre-existed in many jurisdictions. Study of Todak et al. (2024) analysed 50,000 misdemeanour cases, found that BWC involved drug and alcohol cases processed more quickly through the court process in the Arizona municipal court from 2014-2017. This has raised the necessity of proper training with developed toolkits (Bureau of Justice Assistance, 2015) and legislative governance, the deployment of BWC footage as evidence in the Sri Lankan context.

Political Interference

All respondents have shown their concerns about manipulation and political hierarchical Interference. “Informal calls” to release the suspect is one of the deep concerns and conflicts of interest over operations within and outside the legal system. The power imbalance is identified as provisional authority, an operational mechanism practised by police officers that exercises power through a negotiable mechanism with political personnel (Jauregui, 2016). This interference challenges the procedural justice theory by violating legitimacy and neutrality (Tyler, 2006). Self-awareness explains that such situations lead to violating rules merely for the survival of the police officer (Ariel et al., 2018). Disobedience to the higher authorities may result in a work pressure environment, delay in promotions, social exclusion or other ethical dilemmas within the organisation (Bayley, 2001, p. 12).

Bribery and Corruption

Officers use a wide range of tactics to manipulate the BWC monitoring system and obtain the bribe, raising considerable ethical and legal concerns. Excuses such as “Turn off the camera and they went to the washroom”, provide a socially accepted rationale of removing deterrence through physically placing themselves, creating a blind spot. Based on the activation and deactivation of BWC, could create an accountability gap. And this shows that the surveillance may deter the misconduct to a certain extent, but it might be insufficient to eradicate bribery. Furthermore, this may lead to promoting adaptive behaviour to sabotage the equipment (Ariel et al., 2015; Ariel et al., 2018; Kang, 2023; Milidragović et al., 2025). Attempts to solicit bribes through ambiguous coded language are another

challenge found in the study. A statement similar to “Whether I should give you a ticket” may sound like a routine question, but indirectly, the expected tone is pay me something, or I will give you a ticket. Theoretically, the self-awareness theory explains this as a conscious suppression of their own ethical beliefs, avoiding direct demands. Based on the study by Pinker et al. (2008), language has become an optimal linguistic strategy for how corrupt officers tackle the situation through words. This coded language functions as an implicit moral conflic. According to the study of Transparency International, 25% (out of 1300 samples) of respondents who had interaction with the police had to pay bribes, which has generated a negative image of the police department. However, according to deterrence theory, such behaviours exist due to the absence of legal consequences towards such officers.

Socio-Economic Bias

Moreover, the results of the study demonstrated that police-civilian encounters are disturbed by the socio-economic status of the civilian. This has centred around social class and the type of vehicle. Owners with luxurious vehicles received different treatment, while tuk-tuk owners experienced discriminatory treatment that challenges the accountability, trust and legitimacy of the procedural justice system. In such cases, procedural justice theory reflects the necessity of the quality of the decision-making and interpersonal treatment with neutrality that assist to mitigate the personal bias of citizens (Chan et al., 2025). The two studies conducted by Todak et al. (2024) and Voigt et al. (2017) demonstrated that Oakland and Arizona states were supported with ethnic and socioeconomic disparities encountered during police public encounters, even though the situation was supported with BWC evidence. However, the study findings of Demir (2019), Braga, et al. (2020), Todak et al (2024) and Voiget (2017) challenge the results of the study as the recordings help to reduce the unequal disparities among different groups, if the footage process is combined with a higher supervisory level.

Technical and Data Infrastructure

From the perspective of all stakeholders, data storage suspectable for vulnerability which similar to open access without secure, independent protocols and an audit mechanism. The credibility of BWC depends on the infrastructure of its access to recordings and storage. Restricted access to the footage by the IT division of the police may be overwhelming, as the formal access might be controlled through superiors, combined with political interference (Guzik et al., 2021b; Yufeng Wang et al., 2015). According to Mohr (1969), “competence and wealth are significant resources for innovation”, where he argues that financial stability is one of the major concerns in facilitating resources for an institution (Andreescu & Kim, 2022). Bud (2016) and Lum et al. (2020) have shown that funding opportunities have more impact on improving police performance. Moreover, according to White and Malm’s (2020) writing, data storage is a great challenge for the Police Department. Callahan (2016) sees this through storage as a greater challenge, as many police departments have to pay more than $1million per year to store the videos for thirty days due to the limited capacity of data storage. Following an open bidding system for the local and international tech market is one of the essential processes where the law enforcement agency can match its budget with the vendors' market with transparency. Moreover, continuous maintenance of the equipment is one of the significant aspects that needs to be

focused on to continue the process. Delay in facilitating necessary maintenance would discourage the police officers from continuing the process, ensuring the investment matches the benefits for police officers as well as civilians.

4.3 Limitations

This study identified several limitations. The most noticeable limitation of the study is the small sample. This has affected the generalisability of the study findings, as the sample includes specific types of individuals, which impacts the diversity of the perspectives and affects the openness of certain responses. Community groups like LGBTQI, tuk-tuk drivers and lower-income civilians who are directly affected by the police harassment were not included in the sample. The researcher suggests a community-based participatory study to ensure that the voice of these communities has been addressed properly. This may include personal bias, where the responses with a more professional perspective of BWC deployment impact the validity of the findings. Moreover, the auto-generated transcripts during Zoom and Microsoft were manually corrected by the researcher alone. Absence of the second coder may affect the validity of the findings. Also, the researcher did not acknowledge the demographics of the respondents that affect the reflexivity of the study. This has limited the researcher's ability to determine whether the identified themes actually reflect the participants' perceptions or the researcher's bias at the time of doing the analysis. Furthermore, perceptions of the stakeholders depend on the context and a certain time frame in which the policies are addressed.

5.0 CONCLUSION

BWC deployment is not merely a technical implementation, but a structural reform implementation in the Sri Lankan Criminal Justice System. Drawing the overall picture of the study, the Sri Lankan police environment is challenged with the absence of legal and legislative measures, taking bribes through coded language, political interference through informal calls and different treatments for civilians according to their socioeconomic status. However, the findings of the study make clear that these systemic challenges need institutional attention. Moreover, communities like marginalised groups, low-income and vulnerable civilians who are disproportionately discriminated against by the system would benefit from BWC deployment. This study emphasises a meaningful approach for improving the professionalism of police officers and civilians, a fair trial system, and long-term evidence preservation, as well as reduce submitting fabricated evidence within the Criminal Justice System in Sri Lanka. Conversely, it is important to establish a preliminary legislative framework related to the BWC before its implementation for a transformative procedural justice system. However, such framework must be launched with no zero interference of political will, with a strict, proper legal framework that simply impacts the criminal justice system that citizens can trust.

6.0 RECOMMENDATIONS

Firstly, developing a pilot framework for the deployment of BWC is important. And for feasible results, these pilot projects should carry out two different policing environments, such as in Western and Northern provinces. The pilot project should be overseen by the independent authority developed through the officer training guidelines. This would help to identify technical and cultural differences in demographic backgrounds.

Furthermore, arranging training programmes for officials related to technical competence and procedural justice is another important aspect (Hamm et al., 2022). These training programmes must include operational guidelines for device usage, activation protocols, footage handling, and data security obligations. For an effective training, it should be differentiated according to the rank of the police officers. Additionally, access to these recordings must be arranged through rank-based strategies, as the Sri Lanka Police functions with a hierarchical order.

The next recommendation is to enact proper legislation related to BWC for the national deployment that aligns with the common law (Saulnier, 2024). These laws should consist of mandatory BWC activation and deactivation policies. Regarding the data retention period, it should be aligned from 90 days to 5 years for formal investigation. Penalties and imprisonment for the disclosure of footage should also be established for the deterrence effect.

Furthermore, developing a privacy framework for vulnerable groups connected with community co-partnership arrangements will help to ensure their safety. This framework ensures police do not use BWCs purposefully in areas where the most vulnerable communities live (Taylor et al., 2017). Finally, Establish Whistle-blower protection for officers (Fardiansyah et al., 2024). The proposed BWC-related legal documents should include protection for the officers who record or report politically related issues, including the influences towards superiors through informal calls to release suspects. Protection for the whistleblowers should include proper anonymous reporting channels to the independent oversight authorities and prohibit extreme career action. Furthermore, implementing rigorous penalties for officers who are involved in political influence is important to deter such activities.

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APPENDIX

Appendix 01

Interview Questions for Police, Civilians and Legal Professionals on BWC Initiation

"Thank you for agreeing to participate in this interview. My name is Chamuddika Gamage, and I am a postgraduate student in the Department of Criminology, Malmö University, Sweden. This study is supervised by Dr Zoran Vasiljevic, Senior Lecturer, Department of Criminology, Malmö University. This interview will take approximately 30 to 60 minutes. Everything you share will be kept strictly confidential and anonymous, and your name or any identifying details will not be included in the research. You are free to decline to answer any question or to withdraw from the interview at any time without any consequences. Your personal details, including name and contact details, won't be used or shared with anyone outside of the research. With your permission, I would like to audio-record this interview to ensure accuracy. The recording will be used only for academic purposes and will be securely stored. By body-worn cameras, I refer to small cameras attached to police uniforms that record interactions between police officers and members of the public. There are no right or wrong answers in this interview. I am interested in your personal experiences and opinions. If you have any questions for me at any point, let me know".

SECTION 01

The purpose of this section is to build up a rapport with the interviewee. Section one will be necessary only for the legal experts

01. Could you elaborate on your professional background?

SECTION 02

The purpose of this section is to explore the knowledge of BWC and their understanding of the utilisation of the legal system

02. What is your perception of BWC as a policing tool?

SECTION 03

To understand how BWC may enhance the transparency, fairness and due process from the legal perspective.

03. As a law enforcement/ legal professional or civilian, what sort of benefits do you think BWC could bring to the procedural justice process and policing in the Sri Lankan context?

SECTION 04

This section aims to understand the deterrence effects of BWC on the misconduct of law enforcement.

04. Do you believe the presence of video evidence could deter procedural violations by police officers? Why or why not?

SECTION 05

This section will assess how BWC can promote professional behaviour among law enforcement officials and Civilians.

05. What is your perception of the recordings of BWC that impact on police behaviour during investigations, traffic arrests, or interrogations related to traffic?

SECTION 06

This section will explore how BWC footage affects evidence quality and the judicial process.

06. What legal and procedural challenges could be anticipated in the implementation of body-worn cameras within the context of Sri Lanka's existing legislative and societal frameworks?
07. What sort of ethical or privacy concerns might arise from police recording civilians using body-worn cameras?
08. How might body-worn cameras affect public confidence in the criminal justice system in Sri Lanka?

SECTION 07

To capture the recommendations and final reflections for policy.

09. In your opinion, what regulations should be in place before body-worn cameras are implemented in Sri Lanka?

SECTION 8

10. Overall, do you believe the potential benefits of body-worn cameras outweigh the challenges in Sri Lanka? Why or why not?
11. Is there anything else you would like to add regarding body-worn cameras and procedural justice in Sri Lankan policing?

Appendix 02

Form

Information Appendix 1

Project title: Perceptions of Body-Worn Camera Implementation and Procedural Justice in Policing: A Qualitative Study in the Sri Lankan Context	**Date:** 10/02/2026
Study manager: Lochani Chamuddika **Your e-mail** chamuddika@gamil.com **Supervisor: Zoran Vasiljevic** **E-mail:**zoran.vasiljevic@mau.se	**Studying at Malmö University,** **Faculty of Health and Society,** **S-205 06 Malmö,** **Phone +46 40 665 70 00** **Education:** MSc in Criminology **Level: Master Thesis**

Dear Participant,

My name is KGL Chamuddika, who currently enrolled in the MSc in Criminology degree, Department of Criminology, Faculty of Health and Society, Malmö University, Sweden. This study is supervised by Dr Zoran Vasiljevic, Senior Lecturer, Department of Criminology, Malmö University. With permission, the supervisor's contact details are provided for any academic or ethical inquiries related to the study.

The overall aim of this study is to investigate the procedural benefits and challenges of BWC deployment from the perspective of stakeholders in Sri Lanka. The target sample will include law enforcement, civilian and legal experts. This research consists of two research objectives as follows;

- To identify the procedural benefits that stakeholders perceive in implementing BWC in the Sri Lankan Criminal Justice System.
- To identify challenges or risks that stakeholders perceive in relation to implementing BWC in Sri Lanka

Participants will be selected through purposive sampling, focusing on individuals with relevant experience and involvement in the subject matter. Each interview will be conducted for a duration of 30 to 60 minutes at a mutually agreed-upon time and online platform (Zoom or Microsoft Teams). Participation in this study carries no associated risks. Participation is entirely voluntary, and participants have the right to withdraw from the study at any time, without the need for an explanation and without facing any negative repercussions.

The researcher assures participants that the confidentiality of the collected data will be rigorously maintained. Access to the research materials will be restricted to authorized personnel only. All data collected will be anonymized and securely stored on the researcher's local device, ensuring a high standard of password data protection. The findings of this study are intended solely for academic purposes. Results may be presented in academic contexts, such as seminars, conferences, or scholarly publications. Participants will remain entirely unidentifiable in any dissemination of the results.

You are hereby willing to participate in this study.